

Short Entries for 1858 and 1859

January 29th, 1858. I was appointed by the authorities of the stake to [go] on a preaching mission to the Settlements down South in Dixie in company with some other brethren. We held meetings at Fort Harmony & Washington (which was call'd the cotton farm), some 30 miles distance from Harmony. There were some 30 families at this place. The climate very warm and pleasant. Saw several of the sisters wearing cloth from the cotton raised here. The next day we went to Santa Clara an Indian Missionary Station. By request I sang several songs. The next day we return'd to Harmony. In the morning when we left Washington it was so warm for ten miles that we had to ride in our shirt sleeves, but before we got over the Black Ridge we encountered a severe snow storm with a heavy north wind and it was with difficulty that we kept from freezing. I was so num'd when we got to Harmony that I could not dismount from the mule without assistance. Reached home in Cedar City on the 3rd of February where I staid until I went to Parowan on the 13th.

March 30th. The mail arrived from Salt Lake City and brought a circular containing instructions from Pres. Brigham Young to the saints. The main substance of the circular was to the effect that the Saints must leave Salt Lake City and all the settlements north and go as far as Provo for the present and prepare their houses and improvements to be burned and laid in ashes rather than the army should come in to enjoy them. The saints in this and all the other southern settlements are call'd upon to send teams to assist in the removal of the poor, machinery, etc.

April 10th. I was appointed recorder and auditor of public accounts by the City Council.

During the spring of 1858 a number of horse teams were sent to San Bernardino in California to assist in moving the brethren and their families back to Utah.

July 25th. Amasa Lyman and Geo. A. Smith came to Cedar and preached principally on the necessity of home manufacture and that before this people could become a rich and independent people they would have to quit running to Gentile stores.

September 11th. I was elected a member of the City Council.

November 1st, 1858. Attended a meeting of the Deseret Iron Company held in the company's store. The report showed that the works have been attended with less success this year than ever and yet an immense amount of labor and means has been expended. A letter has been lately received from Pres. Brigham Young directing the works to be stopped, which was addressed to Isaac Haight, manager of the works. The manager's salary it appears has been fifteen hundred dollars a year and that of the secretary, C. J. Arthur, one thousand dollars a year. Considerable means was furnished by the Tithing office and Store goods sent by the church from Salt Lake had been used

by the general managements to a great extent, when many of the laborers who performed the hard work have received but little in consequence of which many became discouraged and left for other places to better their condition as this is considered a poor place for farming.

During the remainder of the year and until **February, 1859**, I was very busily engaged, principally as a home missionary and many other duties when on the 21st of February I accompanied Pres. Isaac Haight on a preaching mission to the southern settlements. Visited Harmony, Toquerville, Washington and Virgin City, together with Santa Clara. Arrived home on the **1st of March, 1859**.

During my absence while in England on a mission, Pres. B. Young and Co. made his annual visit through the settlements south of Salt Lake and while in Cedar by his direction another town site was surveyed on the bench near to the mouth of the canyon as he did not consider the old fort site safe from floods as coal creek was subject to very high water in time of flood.

I bought a little Pihede Indian boy about 4 or 5 years old from an old Parvan Chief. I gave him an old rifle, a sack of flour, a shirt and an old pair of pants. We gave him the name of Ammon.

About this time I bought a house and lot in the new city and on the 6th of April moved into it from the old fort.

On **Sunday, the 31st of July, 1859**, Apostle Geo. A. Smith drove up to my house about noon, dined with us and at two o'clock attended meeting. After the usual exercises he arose and said "The President has instructed me to come and disorganize this Stake of Zion and to make a Bishop and President out of one man, and I nominate Bro. Henry Lunt as that man," which was seconded by several voices when Bro. Smith put it to vote which was unanimous. Bro. Smith then invited me to him and placed his hands upon my head and ordain'd me a Bishop and to preside over the Cedar City Ward. I can truly say that I felt my inability to fulfill this high and important trust, yet I know that the Lord is able by his spirit to qualify His servants to do anything he calls them to do if they will live humble and faithful.

September 25th. Went to the semi-annual conference of the church at Salt Lake City accompanied by my wife, Mary Ann, and child and returned home on the 20th of October. Had a very enjoyable and prosperous time.

The numerous duties devolving upon me as Bishop in addition to having to farm my own land for a living for myself and family it seem'd impossible for me to find time to write a daily journal.